

SANDMAN

The villain who slips through Spidey's fingers



With the ability to change his body into grains of sand and reshape it at will, Sandman has proven to be a dangerous and slippery foe for SPIDER-MAN, the FANTASTIC FOUR, and the HULK. Born William Baker in one of the rougher areas of New York City, he had a bad start in life. His father abandoned him and his mother when William was three years old, and the boy grew up in poverty. He quickly learned to steal and cheat.

A LIFE OF CRIME

William was kicked out of high school for taking money to throw a big football game, but soon found work with a protection racket. He took the alias "Flint Marko," and became a success in New York's crime underworld. After an arrest and a jailbreak, Marko headed south. He was on a beach near a military testing site in Georgia when a nuclear reactor's steam system exploded, knocking him unconscious. Marko woke to find that his body now had the properties of sand. Revelling in his new ability, he called himself Sandman and set out on a major criminal career. Sandman battled Spider-Man (his main nemesis), and many other Super Heroes. He joined the WIZARD, TRAPSTER, and MEDUSA to form the FRIGHTFUL FOUR and teamed up with five more of Spider-Man's foes to form the SINISTER SIX.



When he hardens the sand particles that make up his body into a solid block, Sandman packs an incredibly powerful punch.

GOOD OR EVIL?

When Sandman teamed up with HYDRO-MAN, an accident caused the two to merge into a mud creature. After he was freed, Sandman gave up crime, becoming a probationary member of the AVENGERS. The WIZARD brainwashed him into believing that his rejection of crime was a put-on, and he rejoined the Sinister Six. Another member, VENOM, betrayed Sandman; his bite causing Sandman's sand grains to wash away, casting up on various New York beaches. The sand particles of his body managed to find each other, and the Sandman was reborn. The Sandman turned to Spider-Man for help in clearing his father's name in the murder of BEN PARKER from Earth-6078. They succeeded after discovering the killer was the CHAMELEON of 2211. **MT, MF**

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• *Amazing Spider-Man Annual*

#1 Sandman, Vulture, Mysterio, Electro, Kraven the Hunter, and Doctor Octopus get together to form the Sinister Six.

• *Amazing Spider-Man* #217-218

Sandman teams up with Hydro-Man, but a freak accident merges the two villains into a mud creature.

Sandman can alter all of his body at once or just selective parts, as in this example of his right arm changing while the rest of his body remains in its human-looking form.



When Sandman and Hydro-Man combined they became the Mud-Thing, the new creature proved to be a big attraction.



FACTFILE

REAL NAME

William Baker

OCCUPATION

Former professional criminal

BASE

Brooklyn, New York

HEIGHT 6 ft 1 in

WEIGHT 450 lbs

EYES Brown

HAIR Brown

FIRST APPEARANCE

Amazing Spider-Man #4
(September 1963)

SANDMAN

POWERS

Sandman is able to change all or part of his body into a sand-like substance which he can form into any shape. He can spread out the grains of sand in his body to avoid attack, project them outward at high speeds, or harden them into a super-powered weapon.